

ACI: Artfully Crafted Intelligence

A Family Namespace for Human-AI Collaboration Protocols,
Languages, Runtimes, and Specifications

Author: David Lee Wise | **Organisation:** Bridge-Burners LLC | **Contact:** TriPod / ROOT0
Date of Disclosure: June 26, 2026 | **Version:** 0.1 | **Namespace Root:** ACI

ABSTRACT

This disclosure establishes **ACI (Artfully Crafted Intelligence)** as a family namespace for a coherent set of human-AI collaboration protocols, languages, runtimes, and specifications. The namespace is organised as a taxonomy of named members, each prefixed by a role-specific letter (H for human-facing, M for machine-facing, D for distributed), sharing a common architectural foundation (ACI Core). The first defined member is **HACI (Human Artfully Crafted Intelligence)**, a semantic Markdown profile for deterministic role attribution in collaboratively authored documents, specified in a companion publication. This document defines the namespace itself, distinguishes its expansion from existing uses of the acronym ACI, establishes the taxonomy of current and anticipated members, and reserves the naming convention as prior art.

1. NAMESPACE DEFINITION

1.1 The Expansion: Artfully Crafted Intelligence

The acronym ACI is established with the specific expansion **Artfully Crafted Intelligence**. This expansion is deliberately distinct from all known prior uses of the ACI acronym in AI literature, which include Artificial Creative Intelligence (University of Colorado, art/academic), Artificial Capable Intelligence (TechRepublic, capability framing), and Artificial Coherence Intelligence (SSRN, formal coherence). No prior public use of the phrase "Artfully Crafted Intelligence" as an expansion of ACI was found in a comprehensive search of academic databases, package registries, and technical publications as of the date of this disclosure.

The word "**Artfully**" is chosen with intent. It signals that the systems built under this namespace are not merely functional but deliberately designed with craft, discipline, and aesthetic consideration. The word "**Crafted**" emphasises construction by hand and by intent, distinguishing from emergent or accidental intelligence. Together, "Artfully Crafted" positions the namespace as a design philosophy, not merely a technical category.

1.2 The Namespace as an Architectural Pattern

ACI is not a single product, protocol, or specification. It is a **family namespace**: a coherent naming convention under which multiple related components are organised, each identified by a role-prefix letter followed by the root acronym. The pattern is:

[ROLE LETTER] + ACI

where ROLE LETTER indicates the domain:

H	= Human-facing	(HACI)
M	= Machine-facing	(MACI)
D	= Distributed	(DACI)
(none)	= Core	(ACI Core)

This pattern is intentionally extensible. New members may be added by defining a new role-prefix letter, without modifying the namespace root or existing members. The namespace grows by accretion, not by revision.

2. TAXONOMY OF MEMBERS

2.1 ACI Core — The Shared Foundation

ACI Core is the architectural foundation shared by all family members. It defines the common principles, data models, and interface contracts that ensure interoperability across the namespace. ACI Core is not a user-facing product; it is the substrate on which members are built.

Core principles inherited by all members: (1) deterministic communication between human and machine participants; (2) explicit attribution of authorship and authority; (3) separation of intent from evidence; (4) minimal syntax with maximal compatibility; (5) external anchoring for trust and provenance.

2.2 HACI — Human Artfully Crafted Intelligence

HACI is the first defined member of the ACI family. It is a semantic Markdown profile for deterministic role attribution in documents co-authored by humans and AI systems. HACI uses two prefix symbols (! for human commands, ? for questions), one case convention (first alphabetic character determines Documentation vs AI attribution), and three inherited Markdown constructs (> for evidence, # for headings, code fences for executable code). The HACI specification, reference parser, and self-hosting verification are described in a companion defensive publication.

Property	Value
Full Name	Human Artfully Crafted Intelligence
File Extension	.haci
Base Format	Markdown (profile, not replacement)
Parser Complexity	Single-pass, line-by-line, O(n)
New Symbols	2 (! and ?)
Status	Specified, reference implementation complete
Companion Document	HACI Defensive Publication (separate filing)

2.3 MACI — Machine Artfully Crafted Intelligence

MACI is a reserved namespace member for machine-facing protocols within the ACI family. Where HACI addresses the human-readable document layer (how humans and machines co-author text), MACI is intended to address the machine-to-machine communication layer: how AI systems exchange structured intent, proposals, and evidence with each other in a deterministic, attributable

format.

Anticipated scope: inter-agent communication protocols, structured proposal/approval workflows between AI systems, machine-readable role attribution in API exchanges, and deterministic serialisation of collaborative decision chains. MACI is reserved but not yet specified.

2.4 DACI — Distributed Artfully Crafted Intelligence

DACI is a reserved namespace member for distributed and multi-agent coordination within the ACI family. Where HACI and MACI address bilateral (human-machine or machine-machine) collaboration, DACI is intended to address coordination across multiple participants, potentially including multiple humans, multiple AI systems, and hybrid groups.

Anticipated scope: consensus protocols for multi-agent authorship, distributed provenance chains, conflict resolution when multiple participants modify the same document or decision tree, and mesh-topology communication patterns for collaborative intelligence. DACI is reserved but not yet specified.

3. NAMESPACE ARCHITECTURE

```
ACI – Artfully Crafted Intelligence
|
+-- ACI Core
|   Shared principles, data models, interface contracts
|   Deterministic communication / explicit attribution /
|   intent-evidence separation / minimal syntax / external anchoring
|
+-- HACI (Human ACI)
|   Semantic Markdown profile for human-AI document authoring
|   File extension: .haci
|   Status: SPECIFIED (v0.1)
|
+-- MACI (Machine ACI)
|   Machine-to-machine collaboration protocols
|   Status: RESERVED
|
+-- DACI (Distributed ACI)
|   Multi-agent coordination and consensus
|   Status: RESERVED
|
+-- [future members]
    Pattern: [ROLE LETTER] + ACI
    Extensible by accretion
```

4. EXTENSIBILITY AND FUTURE MEMBERS

The ACI namespace is designed for extensibility without fragmentation. New members are added by defining a role-prefix letter and a specification document, without modifying ACI Core or existing members. The following naming conventions are established:

Convention	Rule
Naming	[Single uppercase letter] + ACI (e.g., HACI, MACI, DACI)

Specification	Each member has its own specification document
File Extensions	Derived from member name: .haci, .maci, .daci
Core Inheritance	All members inherit ACI Core principles
Independence	Members do not depend on each other; only on ACI Core
Versioning	Each member is versioned independently

Anticipated future members and tooling within the namespace include but are not limited to:

- HACI Script** — a scripting layer for automating HACI document workflows (template generation, role validation, compliance checking).
- HACI Parser** — the reference parser (already implemented as `haci.py`; future implementations in JavaScript, Rust, and other languages).
- HACI Linter** — a validation tool that checks HACI documents for role consistency, unclosed fences, missing version headers, and case-convention violations.
- HACI Language Server** — an LSP-compatible language server providing real-time role highlighting, diagnostics, and autocompletion in editors (VS Code, Vim, Emacs).
- ACI Registry** — a namespace registry documenting all defined members, their specifications, versions, and status (specified, reserved, deprecated).

5. DIFFERENTIATION FROM PRIOR ACI USES

The acronym ACI has multiple established expansions in AI literature. This disclosure does not claim ownership of the acronym itself but establishes the specific expansion "Artfully Crafted Intelligence" and its associated namespace, taxonomy, naming convention, and member definitions as novel contributions. The following table distinguishes this disclosure from known prior uses:

Expansion	Source	Domain	Overlap with This Disclosure
Artificial Creative Intelligence	Univ. of Colorado	Art / academic	None — different expansion, different domain
Artificial Capable Intelligence	TechRepublic	Capability framing	None — different expansion, different scope
Artificial Coherence Intelligence	SCEN	Formal coherence	None — different expansion, different focus
Artfully Crafted Intelligence	This disclosure	Collaboration protocols	THIS IS THE NOVEL CONTRIBUTION

6. RELATIONSHIP TO THE HACI SPECIFICATION

The HACI specification (documented in a companion defensive publication) is the first concrete member of the ACI family. This document establishes the namespace; the HACI document specifies the first protocol within it. The two publications are designed to be read together but are independently valid. The HACI specification defines the .haci file format, the three-symbol grammar, the case convention, and the reference parser. This document defines the family architecture that HACI sits within, the naming convention that future members will follow, and the extensibility model that allows the namespace to grow without fragmentation.

7. SCOPE OF DISCLOSURE

This publication is a defensive disclosure intended to establish prior art and prevent the patenting of the following concepts by any party:

- (a) The specific expansion "Artfully Crafted Intelligence" for the acronym ACI, and its use as a family namespace for human-AI collaboration protocols, languages, runtimes, and specifications.
- (b) The naming convention [ROLE LETTER] + ACI, specifically including HACI (Human), MACI (Machine), and DACI (Distributed), as identifiers for members of the ACI family.
- (c) The architectural pattern of a shared core (ACI Core) defining common principles and interface contracts inherited by all family members, with members independently versioned and specified.
- (d) The extensibility model in which new family members are added by defining a role-prefix letter and a specification document, without modifying existing members or the namespace root.
- (e) The file extensions .haci, .maci, and .daci as identifiers for documents, data, or communication streams conforming to their respective ACI family member specifications.
- (f) The anticipated tooling namespace including but not limited to HACI Script, HACI Parser, HACI Linter, HACI Language Server, and ACI Registry as components of the ACI ecosystem.

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David Lee Wise / Bridge-Burners LLC / 2026-06-26